ELI v2.0 — New User Installation Guide

ELI v2.1.11

July 2026

Contents

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> **Updated for v2.1.11 (July 2026).** The primary way to install ELI is now the **prebuilt installers on GitHub Releases** — `ELI-Setup-<v>.exe` (Windows), the `.dmg` (macOS, Apple Silicon), the `.AppImage` (Linux). The Linux AppImage and Windows installer are built and launch-tested in CI; the macOS `.dmg` is built on a Mac and provided best-effort (not verified in CI). First launch offers GPU acceleration (NVIDIA CUDA / AMD Vulkan; Apple Metal is built in) and a starter model sized to your hardware. Data lives in a per-user `ELI_v2` folder and survives upgrades; `--fresh-start` resets it. Everything below remains valid for **source installs** (clone + `install.sh`) and the classic portable tarball.

Version: 2.1.11
Audience: First-time users on Linux, Windows, or macOS
Release page: https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases/tag/v2.1.11

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1. What you are installing

ELI is a **local-first AI assistant**. Everything runs on your computer:

- Chat and reasoning (powered by a GGUF model you download)
- Memory, knowledge graph, and habits
- Desktop GUI (PySide6) and optional web interface for phone/tablet
- Voice input (Whisper STT) and voice output (Piper TTS)
- Offline by default — no cloud account required

Honest hardware note: Best tested on **Linux x86_64 + NVIDIA GPU**. Windows and macOS work; AMD and Apple Silicon are supported in code but less field-tested.

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2. Choose your package (same software, different wrapper)

Package	OS	What it is	Best for
Portable folder	Linux, Windows, macOS	Extracted directory with scripts	Tinkerers, USB drives, devs
AppImage	Linux only	Single executable file	Easiest Linux double-click
Setup.exe	Windows only	Graphical installer	Easiest Windows install
Source clone	All	Git checkout + `install.sh`	Contributors, bleeding edge

Important: None of the release downloads include the large **chat model** (~2–5 GB). That is downloaded during first-time setup. Voice models (~200 MB) and the memory embedder (~85 MB) are fetched automatically by the installer.

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3. Prerequisites (all platforms)

Requirement	Details
Python	3.10, 3.11, or 3.12
Disk space	~10 GB free (venv + one chat model + voice)
RAM	16 GB recommended; 8 GB minimum with a small model
GPU	NVIDIA recommended; CPU-only works but slower
Network	Required once during install (model + voice downloads)

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4. Linux — Portable folder (recommended for control)

4.1 Download and extract

```
cd ~/Desktop
wget https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases/download/v2.1.11/ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable.tar.g
tar -xzf ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable.tar.gz
cd ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable
```

4.2 First-time setup (run once)

Easiest — guided setup (recommended):

```
chmod +x ELI_Setup.sh
./ELI_Setup.sh
```

This runs eight steps automatically:

1. Welcome and Python check
2. Create `.venv` and install pip dependencies (`install.sh`)
3. Download a chat model sized to your GPU (or skip if present)
4. Initialize local databases
5. Download voice models (Whisper STT + Piper TTS) and memory embedder

6. Install app-menu icons (ELI v2.0, ELI Server, ELI Setup)
7. Open the graphical setup wizard
8. Launch ELI

Manual equivalent:

```
chmod +x INSTALL_ELI.sh RUN_ELI.sh install.sh
./INSTALL_ELI.sh
./RUN_ELI.sh
```

4.3 What the installer downloads

```
# Voice (STT + TTS) - automatic during install
.venv/bin/python -m eli.runtime.voice_assets

# Memory embedder - automatic during install
.venv/bin/python -m eli.core.model_download --aux

# Chat model - offered in wizard, or run manually:
.venv/bin/python -m eli.core.model_download --list    # see options
.venv/bin/python -m eli.core.model_download --auto    # pick by VRAM
```

VRAM guide (NVIDIA):

GPU VRAM	Suggested model
8 GB	Qwen2.5-7B Q4 (~4.5 GB)
12 GB	Qwen2.5-14B Q4 or Mistral-7B
24 GB+	Larger quantised models

4.4 Daily use (after setup)

```
cd ~/Desktop/ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable

# Desktop GUI
./RUN_ELI.sh
# or
./eli.sh
# or click "ELI v2.0" in your application menu

# Web server - local PC browser only
./scripts/eli_serve.sh

# Web server - phone/tablet on same Wi-Fi (with microphone)
./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

Unified launcher:

```
./scripts/eli_launch.sh                      # desktop GUI (default)
./scripts/eli_launch.sh serve --lan --https    # web server for phone
./scripts/eli_launch.sh both --lan --https     # server + GUI together
```

4.5 Phone / tablet access

1. Start the server with HTTPS (required for microphone on mobile browsers):

```
./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

2. The terminal prints URLs like:

```
http://192.168.1.118:8081/#token=XXXXXXXX
https://192.168.1.118:8443/#token=XXXXXXXX
```

3. On your phone (same Wi-Fi), open the **HTTP** URL first to connect.
4. For voice/mic, open the **HTTPS** URL and accept the one-time self-signed certificate warning.

Firewall (if phone cannot connect):

```
sudo ufw allow from 192.168.1.0/24 to any port 8081 proto tcp
sudo ufw allow from 192.168.1.0/24 to any port 8443 proto tcp
```

4.6 Linux — AppImage (double-click install)

```
cd ~/Desktop
wget https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases/download/v2.1.11/ELI_v2-2.1.11-x86_64.AppImage
chmod +x ELI_v2-2.1.11-x86_64.AppImage
./ELI_v2-2.1.11-x86_64.AppImage
```

What happens on first launch:

- ELI copies itself to `~/.local/share/ELI_v2`
- Runs `INSTALL_ELI.sh` automatically
- Shows a progress dialog, then launches ELI
- Later launches open ELI directly from `~/.local/share/ELI_v2`

Daily use after AppImage first run:

```
# From the installed copy:
cd ~/.local/share/ELI_v2
./RUN_ELI.sh
./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

Or use the app-menu icons installed during first run.

4.7 Portable vs AppImage — summary

	Portable folder	AppImage
Location	Where you extracted it	Copies to `~/.local/share/ELI_v2`
Start	`./ELI_Setup.sh` then `./RUN_ELI.sh`	`chmod +x` and double-click
Updates	Download new tarball, re-run setup	Download new AppImage
Data	`artifacts/` inside folder	`~/.local/share/ELI_v2/artifacts/`

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5. Windows — Portable zip or Setup.exe

5.1 Download

From https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases/tag/v2.1.11:

- **Portable:** `ELI_v2-2.1.11-windows-portable.zip` — extract anywhere
- **Installer:** `ELI_v2-2.1.11-Setup.exe` — graphical install (if built)

5.2 First-time setup

Easiest — double-click:

```
ELI_Setup.bat
```

PowerShell (full control):

```
cd C:\Users\YourName\Desktop\ELI_v2-2.1.11-windows-portable
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install.ps1 -Yes
```

Command prompt:

```
cd C:\Users\YourName\Desktop\ELI_v2-2.1.11-windows-portable
install.bat
```

Install flags:

```
# CPU only (no NVIDIA GPU)
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install.ps1 -Yes -CpuOnly

# Auto-download chat model after install
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install.ps1 -Yes -AutoModel

# Skip model download (wizard later)
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install.ps1 -Yes -NoModel

# Also install CUDA toolkit via winget
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install.ps1 -Yes -InstallCuda
```

5.3 Daily use

```
eli.bat
```

```
.\scripts\eli_launch.sh gui
```

Web server:

```
# Local only
.\scripts\eli_serve.ps1

# Phone/tablet on LAN (add -Https for microphone)
.\scripts\eli_serve.ps1 -Lan -Https
```

Start Menu shortcuts (after install):

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File scripts\install_desktop_apps.ps1
```

5.4 Windows voice assets (if mic/TTS fails)

```
.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m eli.runtime.voice_assets
```

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6. macOS — Portable or source install

macOS uses the same `install.sh` as Linux (Metal GPU instead of CUDA).

6.1 From portable tarball

```
cd ~/Desktop
curl -LO https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases/download/v2.1.11/ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable.t
tar -xzf ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable.tar.gz
```

```
cd ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable
chmod +x ELI_Setup.sh
./ELI_Setup.sh
```

6.2 From source (git clone)

```
git clone https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0.git
cd ELI_v2.0
bash install.sh --yes
./eli.sh
```

6.3 Daily use

```
./RUN_ELI.sh
./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

Finder launchers (installed by `install_desktop_apps.sh`):

```
~/Applications/ELI v2.0.command
~/Applications/ELI Server (Web App).command
~/Applications/ELI Setup.command
```

6.4 macOS system dependencies (optional features)

```
brew install tesseract ffmpeg portaudio
```

---

7. First-run wizard (all platforms)

After install, ELI opens a setup window. Complete these steps:

1. **Hardware profile** — ELI detects your GPU/RAM and suggests settings
2. **Chat model** — pick or download a GGUF model (required for replies)
3. **Onboarding** — ELI asks your name, work, answer style, and focus
    - Type your real name when asked ("What should I call you?")
    - Say `skip` at any time to skip onboarding

If you answered onboarding wrong, reset and start over:

```
cd /path/to/ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable    # or your install root
export ELI_PROJECT_ROOT="$PWD" PYTHONPATH="$PWD"
.venv/bin/python <<'PY'
from pathlib import Path
import json, sqlite3
from eli.kernel.state import clear_user_name
from eli.onboarding.interview import clear_onboarding_state

clear_onboarding_state()
clear_user_name()
cfg = Path("config/settings.json")
s = json.loads(cfg.read_text())
s["user_name"] = ""
s["first_run_complete"] = False
cfg.write_text(json.dumps(s, indent=2) + "\n")
db = Path("artifacts/db/user.sqlite3")
con = sqlite3.connect(db)
for t in ["memories","user_patterns","kg_entities","conversations"]:
    try: con.execute(f"DELETE FROM {t}")
```

```
    except: pass
con.commit()
print("Reset complete - restart ELI")
PY
```

---

8. Folder layout (where your data lives)

```
ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable/
  .venv/                  Python environment (created by install)
  models/
    gguf/                 Chat models you download
    embeddings/           Memory embedder (auto-downloaded)
    whisper/              Speech-to-text weights (auto-downloaded)
    tts/piper/            Text-to-speech voice (auto-downloaded)
  artifacts/
    db/                   SQLite databases (memory, habits, etc.)
    conversations/        Saved chat logs
    runtime/              User profile snapshots
  config/
    settings.json         Your preferences and model path
  scripts/
    eli_serve.sh          Web server launcher
    eli_launch.sh         Unified launcher
    eli_setup.sh          Guided setup
  ELI_Setup.sh            One-click first-time setup
  INSTALL_ELI.sh          Install only
  RUN_ELI.sh              Launch desktop app
  eli.sh                  Launch desktop app (alias)
```

---

9. Troubleshooting

"No GGUF model found" / empty chat replies

Download a chat model:

```
.venv/bin/python -m eli.core.model_download --auto
```

Or set model path in **Settings** → **Model** in the GUI.

STT error: "network disabled" / huggingface.co blocked

Whisper is not cached. Run:

```
.venv/bin/python -m eli.runtime.voice_assets
```

Then restart the server.

TTS 503: "no voice model"

Piper voice missing. Run:

```
.venv/bin/python -m eli.runtime.voice_assets
```

Phone mic does not work

Browsers block microphone on plain `http://LAN-IP`. Use HTTPS:

```
./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

Open the `https://` URL on the phone and accept the certificate warning.

`./scripts/eli_serve.sh: No such file or directory`

You are in the wrong directory. Either:

```
cd /path/to/ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable
./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

Or use the full path:

```
/home/you/Desktop/ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable/scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

Only 9–10 GPU layers on 8 GB card

Use a smaller model (7B, not 35B). In the hardware wizard, pick Qwen2.5-7B.

Re-run full setup safely

```
./ELI_Setup.sh
```

Safe to run multiple times — idempotent.

Diagnostics

```
./eli_diagnose.sh
.venv/bin/python -c "from eli.setup.status import stage_checks; print(stage_checks())"
```

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10. Quick reference — copy-paste commands

Linux portable — full first install

```
wget https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases/download/v2.1.11/ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable.tar.g
tar -xzf ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable.tar.gz
cd ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable
chmod +x ELI_Setup.sh && ./ELI_Setup.sh
```

Linux — daily desktop

```
cd ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable && ./RUN_ELI.sh
```

Linux — phone server with voice

```
cd ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable && ./scripts/eli_serve.sh --lan --https
```

Windows — first install

```
cd ELI_v2-2.1.11-windows-portable
ELI_Setup.bat
```

Windows — daily desktop

```
eli.bat
```

Windows — phone server

```
.\scripts\eli_serve.ps1 -Lan -Https
```

macOS — first install

```
tar -xzf ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable.tar.gz
cd ELI_v2-2.1.11-linux-portable
chmod +x ELI_Setup.sh && ./ELI_Setup.sh
```

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11. What happens during install (technical summary)

Step	Script	Network?	Size
Python venv + pip packages	`install.sh` / `install.ps1`	Yes (PyPI)	~2 GB
Memory embedder	`model_download --aux`	Yes	~85 MB
Voice STT (Whisper)	`voice_assets`	Yes	~150 MB
Voice TTS (Piper amy)	`voice_assets`	Yes	~63 MB
Chat model	wizard or `model_download`	Yes	2–5 GB
Database init	`eli.core.init_data`	No	—
Desktop icons	`install_desktop_apps.sh`	No	—

After install, ELI runs **offline by default**. Only deliberate actions (web search, model download) use the network.

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12. Getting help

- **Release page:** https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/releases
- **Issues:** https://github.com/ShadowESC95/ELI_v2.0/issues
- **Server docs:** `docs/SERVER_AND_WEB_APP.md` (in the install folder)
- **Cross-platform notes:** `docs/CROSS_PLATFORM.md`

ELI v2.0 — local, private, yours. This guide matches release v2.1.11.